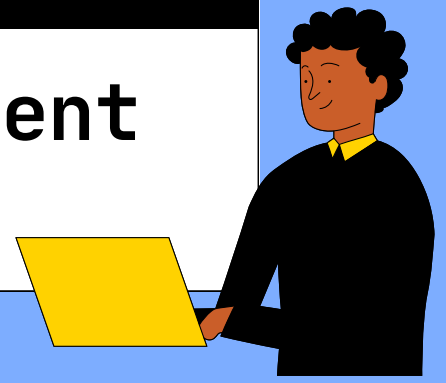


Health Choices Student Handout Packet



 In this activity, you will reflect on the influences affecting your choices and practice the essential skills needed to lead a healthy, substance-free life.



Key Terms

Term	Definition
Influence	A person or thing that has an effect on your beliefs or actions.
Refusal Skills	Communication techniques used to say no to peer pressure or risky situations.
Coping Strategy	A method used to manage difficult emotions, stress, or challenges.
Credibility	The quality of being trusted or believed based on reliable evidence.



Read about Influences and Choices

As you read, ask yourself: how do internal and external pressures shape the decisions that teens make every day?

Adolescence is a time of rapid growth, especially in the brain. The area responsible for decision-making and impulse control is still developing, which can make risky choices feel more appealing in the moment. These choices often have long-term effects on physical health and future goals.

Many factors influence these decisions, including family values, peer pressure, and media messages. Developing strong refusal skills and finding healthy ways to cope with stress are essential tools for navigating these years. By analyzing sources of information and identifying support systems, you can build a roadmap for a successful and healthy future.



Think, Pair, Share

Answer the questions below based on the reading, then discuss your ideas with a partner.

Question	Your Answer	Your Partner's Answer
What specific part of the brain development process mentioned in the text can impact the way teenagers approach making risky decisions?		
Why is the development of refusal skills and healthy coping strategies considered an important step for managing the various influences teens face?		
How does understanding the potential impact of choices on your future goals change the way you might approach a difficult social situation today?		

Prepare what you and your partner will share. **What was similar, different, or noteworthy about your answers?**

We noticed that...

Teaching note



This module covers foundational health topics including substance influence, refusal skills, and stress management. Encourage students to connect the 'My Help Map' activity to their actual personal networks. This was generated by AI to give you a head start — not the final word. You know your students best, so give it a once-over and make it yours.